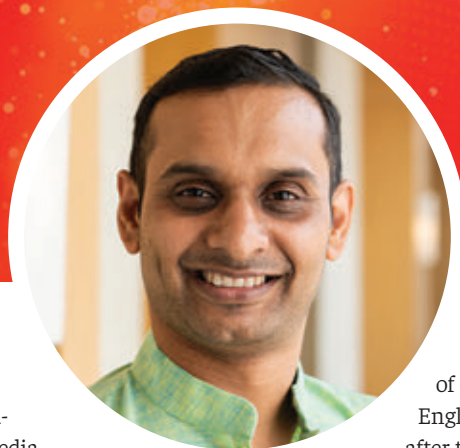


WIKIPEDIA'S INDIA MISSION DEMYSTIFIED

Understanding Wikipedia's roadmap to empower Indians with access to knowledge

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Praveen Das,
Lead Partnerships Manager,
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Love it or hate it, you just can't ignore it. That pretty much sums up Wikipedia for everyone who gets online, doesn't it? Scholars and academics roll their eyes and take it with a pinch of salt, but for the rest of the world Wikipedia has become absolutely essential for looking up any and every kind of information on the internet – receiving over 6.6 billion visits every month, making it the 5th most popular online destination in the world, according to Semrush.

It'd be fair to say that Wikipedia's visitors are innately curious, choosing to go beyond just the result of their search engine keywords in a slightly deeper pursuit to expand their knowledge. Nowhere is this more visible than in India. "Wikipedia is a global platform providing human-generated, encyclopaedic content in over 300 language editions. India has the fourth highest number of views to Wikipedia in the world, with over 1 billion page views per month," confirmed Praveen Das, Lead Partnerships Manager, South Asia at the Wikimedia

Foundation, the nonprofit organisation behind Wikipedia and other Wikimedia projects. This staggering statistic underscores the platform's importance in India, not just as a repository of knowledge but as a tool for empowerment and education.

With its rich tapestry of languages and cultures, India represents a unique challenge and opportunity for Wikipedia. The country boasts the second highest number of internet users in the world, making it a fertile ground for the dissemination and creation of free knowledge. Yet, the challenge lies in reaching every corner of this vast nation, ensuring that the knowledge available is not just in English, but in the myriad of languages spoken across the subcontinent.

Praveen highlights that India is not just a passive consumer of Wikipedia but a significant contributor as well. "In terms of content contributions, India has the third-largest number

of contributors to English Wikipedia after the U.S. and the U.K.; and it leads in content creation within the South Asia region, representing over 70% of the region's informa-

tion on Wikimedia projects," he shares. This vibrant participation is a testament to the country's commitment to knowledge sharing and the potential for further growth in this space. To further understand the nuances of Wikipedia's mission and its India relevance, read the following interview with Praveen Das. Edited excerpts follow:

Q What are some Wikipedia facts that most Indians don't know about?

A Wikipedia is the only top global website operated by a non-profit organisation, the Wikimedia Foundation. The site is not funded by advertising; it does not track your activity, sell your information, or use algorithms to promote content. No matter where you are in the world, which